

PANTHERS

From C1

Nelson cut the Trojans' lead to 59-55 with 41 seconds left. After Trinity's Jerry Schupinski was called for a traveling violation, Nelson caught the twine for a 3-pointer with 26 seconds left, cutting the deficit to 59-58.

Trinity point guard Jeff Springer converted both ends of a one-and-one with 21 seconds left to push the Trojan lead to 61-58. Senior Dave Hatch's 3-point attempt fell off the mark with 13 seconds left, ending EC's comeback hopes.

The Trojan's senior center Adam Bragg put in the final two of his game-high 22 points with a pair of free throws with 11 seconds left to all but seal the verdict.

Bragg's seven rebounds in the final period also proved instrumental for Trinity, which finished with a 41-34 advantage. The Trojans also netted all 10 free throw attempts in the last quarter.

"We talked about coming out attacking earlier in the week, but then we came out slow (14-for-25, first half)," said Bragg, a 6-4 senior. "The last few minutes I just remembered all those buzzer-beaters and two-point games we've gone through the last two years. After awhile, you get accustomed to it and you can handle it."

Nelson held Springer to just five field goal attempts and 10 points, 10 points below his average. But exiting the Panthers' locker room, Nelson's mood was understandably one of disappointment.

"We were trying, but their big guys were tough," said Nelson, who had 13 points. "Coach told us to pass the ball around more tonight, and we were able to set a good tone passing. Things didn't turn out we wanted, but we've got things going in the right direction."

Senior Mike Niederst led EC with 17 points while Hatch followed with 14, while also grabbing

eight rebounds.

The Panthers controlled the game the first 12 minutes, but their fortunes then soured as Trinity scored the final eight points of the half to grab a 31-29 lead at the intermission.

A similar thing happened the last four minutes of the third quarter as Trinity outscored EC 6-2 over to take a 47-43 lead into the final eight minutes.

"Anybody who saw the game knows we could have won it," said Kearns. "The kids played hard and gave themselves a chance to win. That's all you can ask."

After enduring eight straight losing seasons, five as head coach, Trojan head coach Bill Svoboda could appreciate the win after suffering through a 37-70 record since taking over the helm in 1989.

"That's why they made through it," said Svoboda. "They (the seniors) went through 4-17 and 7-14 the last two years. They've got experience, that's why I went with them at the end. When the game is on the road and the conference is on the line, they're going to do them in."

In the junior varsity game, Ryan Mack led the way with 20 points while Mike Groomes added 16 to lead Elyria Catholic (10-3) to victory over Trinity (6-7).

Elyria Catholic returns to action Friday, February 10 at Lorain Catholic.

ELYRIA CATHOLIC										
Player	GA	G	FA	FT	F	P	TR	BL	ST	PTS
Mike Niederst	12	5	7	14	15	17	1	0	0	20
Dave Hatch	12	5	3	3	3	4	1	0	0	14
Rob Peters	15	4	0	0	0	2	2	0	0	8
Nick Bissler	5	1	0	0	0	2	2	0	0	2
Jason Hart	3	1	1	1	1	1	0	0	0	4
Roopen Patel	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Sam Merrill	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Ryan Mack	1	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2
TOTALS	51	20	18	13	18	58	6	0	0	58

TRINITY										
Player	GA	G	FA	FT	F	P	TR	BL	ST	PTS
Mike Springer	6	3	4	4	4	2	10	0	0	10
Mike Prucha	9	4	0	0	1	1	10	0	0	8
Adam Bragg	14	6	6	6	6	11	22	0	0	22
Joe Bozse	4	4	0	0	0	0	5	0	0	8
Dan Straight	3	2	0	0	0	1	5	0	0	4
C. Mitchell	2	1	0	0	0	0	2	0	0	2
Terhan Freeman	2	1	0	0	0	0	2	0	0	2
Jerry Schupinski	1	1	2	2	2	4	0	0	0	4
Jeff Malar	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
TOTALS	44	24	10	12	10	63	55	0	0	63

Score by Quarters										
Trinity	17	14	15	15	61	Elyria Catholic	17	14	15	58
Three-point field goals										
Trinity	EC (5-20)	Nelson (2-6)	Hart (1-3)	Niederst (1-5)	Hatch (1-4)	Peters (0-1)	Bissler (0-1)	Trinity (2-8)	Prucha (2-4)	Straight (1-1)
Elyria Catholic	Malar (0-3)	Springer (0-2)	Junior varsity	Elyria Catholic	65-44					

A. Lake takes step forward

Chris Assenheimer
The Chronicle-Telegram

AVON LAKE — Call Avon Lake's victory over Southwestern Conference rival North Olmsted a step forward while stepping back.

Though the Shoremen looked less than impressive in the low scoring 45-38 affair, a conference win is a conference win, and they've been hard to come by for the defending league champs.

"We're a team trying to re-find ourselves," said A.L. head coach Dick Deasy, whose squad now stands at 8-7 overall and 4-5 in the SWC. Avon Lake began the season with five straight wins before losing seven of its next nine coming into Friday night's engagement. "It was a step forward. We've been exhausting ourselves on defense and struggling on offense, but tonight we finished the game real well."

Unfortunately for North Olmsted coach Tim Schmotzer, his team did not. After taking a two-point advantage into the locker room at intermission — 22-20 — and leading the majority of the game, the Eagles collapsed down the stretch.

Schmotzer's search for an answer was a simple one. NO shot a putrid 6 for 23 from the field in the second half, while scoring just 16 points.

"I thought we got better shots in the second half than we did in the first half, but for whatever reason they weren't falling," said a perplexed Schmotzer, whose Eagles (8-6 overall, 4-4 SWC) lost for just the second time in their last eight contests.

Things weren't much better for the Shoremen, who struggled to find an offensive threat the entire night before the most unlikely of heroes emerged for the maroon and gold.

Freshman Nate Port, who did not see action through the first 16 minutes, opened the final quarter by scoring Avon Lake's first seven points to set the victory wheels in motion. Port's three-point and subsequent driving deuce put the Shoremen in front for good at 37-35 with a little over a minute left on the clock.

"The rookie played well tonight," said Deasy. "His play down the stretch made the win extra special. We were definitely happy to have him along."

NO's Keith Bielozzer stuck his third 3-pointer of the game to bring the Eagles to within a bucket — 40-38 — with nine seconds to play, but a pair of Sean Deasy free throws, followed by a North Olmsted turnover insured they would get no closer. A.L.'s Brian Morrissey buried a long range bomb at the buzzer for the final count.

The Eagles' Aaron Sulzer led all scorers on the evening with 12 points — 10 in the first half — followed by Bielozzer's 11 in the scoring column.

Deasy's 11 points topped Avon Lake and Jason Hurbank was in double figures as well with 10.

Avon Lake has some time to enjoy the 'W,' not playing again until Friday when it hosts Amherst. North Olmsted faces a tough test tonight hosting conference top gun Westlake.

A. Lake										
Player	G	F	T	GA	G	FA	FT	F	P	PTS
Deasy	3	4	11	11	Bielozzer	4	0	1	1	3
Morrissey	1	0	3	3	Maffett	1	0	1	1	3
Hurbank	3	2	10	10	Straub	1	1	1	1	3
Kozlovski	0	1	1	1	Switzer	0	0	0	0	0
Candace	1	3	5	5	Glover	0	1	1	1	1
Ung	4	0	8	8	Borodo	0	0	0	0	0
Jeha	0	0	0	0	Lazada	0	0	0	0	0
Fitz	0	0	0	0	Bozack	0	0	0	0	0
Port	3	0	7	7	Patton	3	0	0	0	6
TOTALS	15	10	45	45	TOTALS	16	3	38		

	1	2	3	4	T
A. Lake	11	9	10	15	45
N Olmsted	15	7	7	9	38
Three-point goals	Avon Lake	Hurbanek	2		
Deasy, Morrissey	Port North Olmsted	Bielozor			
3					
Junior varsity	Avon Lake	40-32			